

DESIGN FRAMEWORK

Design Once. Use Everywhere.

Build a design system that scales — from your first sketch to every screen.

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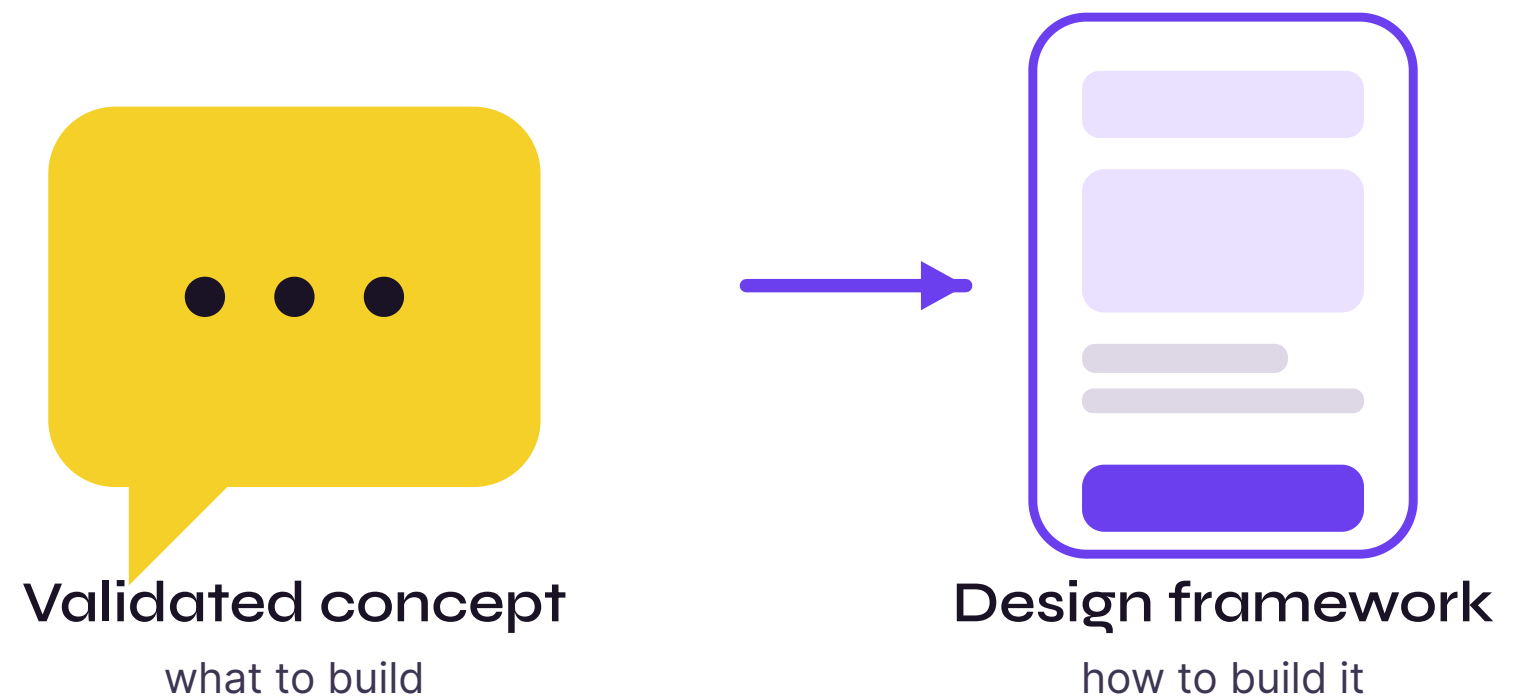
• 45 MIN



WHERE WE LEFT OFF

You know **what** to build. Now build it **right**.

Turn last session's feedback into a system that holds together — no matter how many screens you add.



— FIRST — LET'S HEAR FROM YOU

How do you design **today?**

01 Do you use a design system?

If yes — how do you actually use it day to day?

02 Where does your work feel inconsistent?

Buttons, spacing, colours that never quite match.

03 Ever rebuilt something that already existed?

A component you redrew instead of reusing.

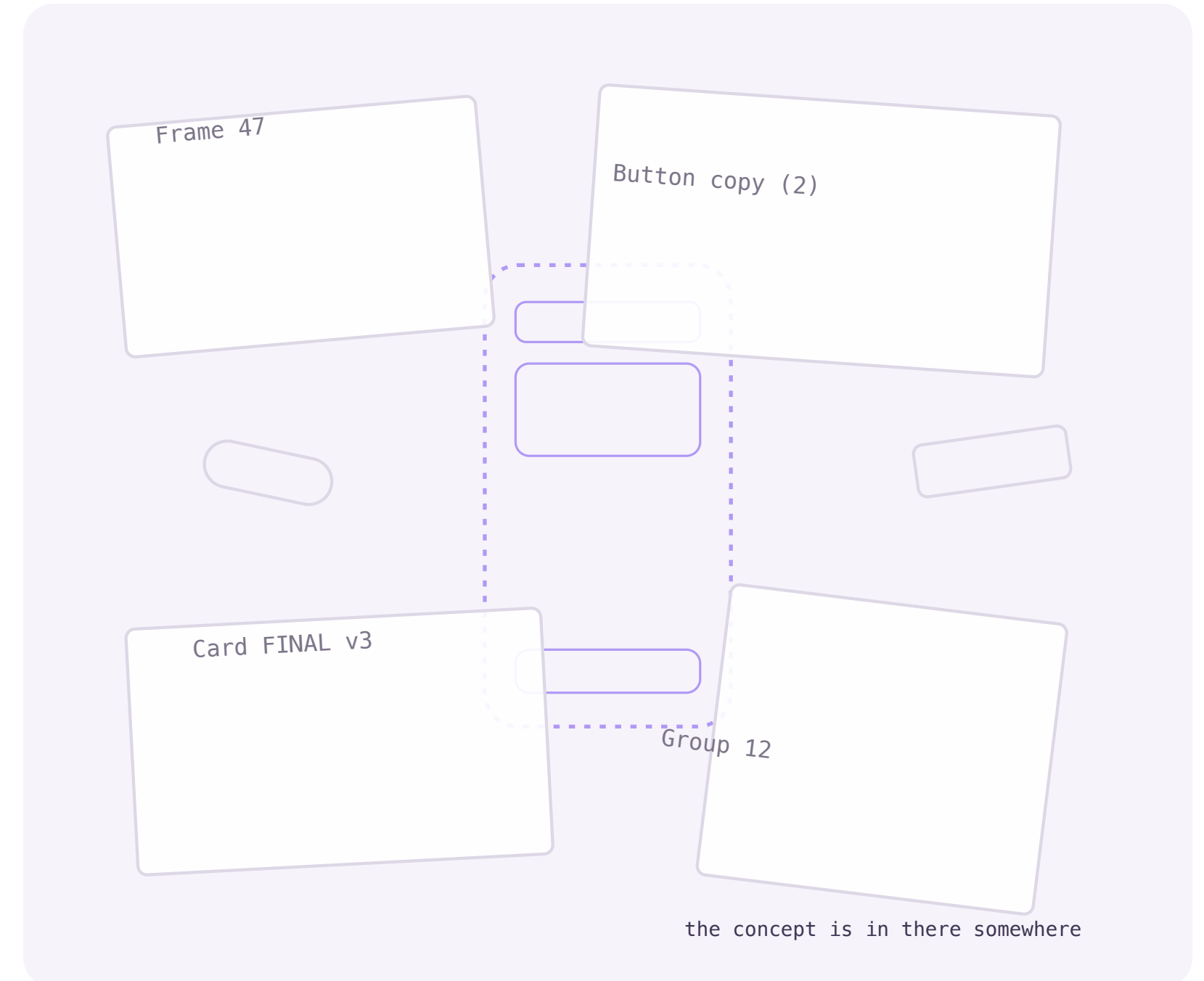
04 What slows you down the most?

The part of designing you wish were easier.

YOU'VE SEEN THIS BEFORE

Without a system, the concept drifts.

Nobody planned it — it just happened, one screen at a time. That's how a concept users loved becomes something nobody recognises.

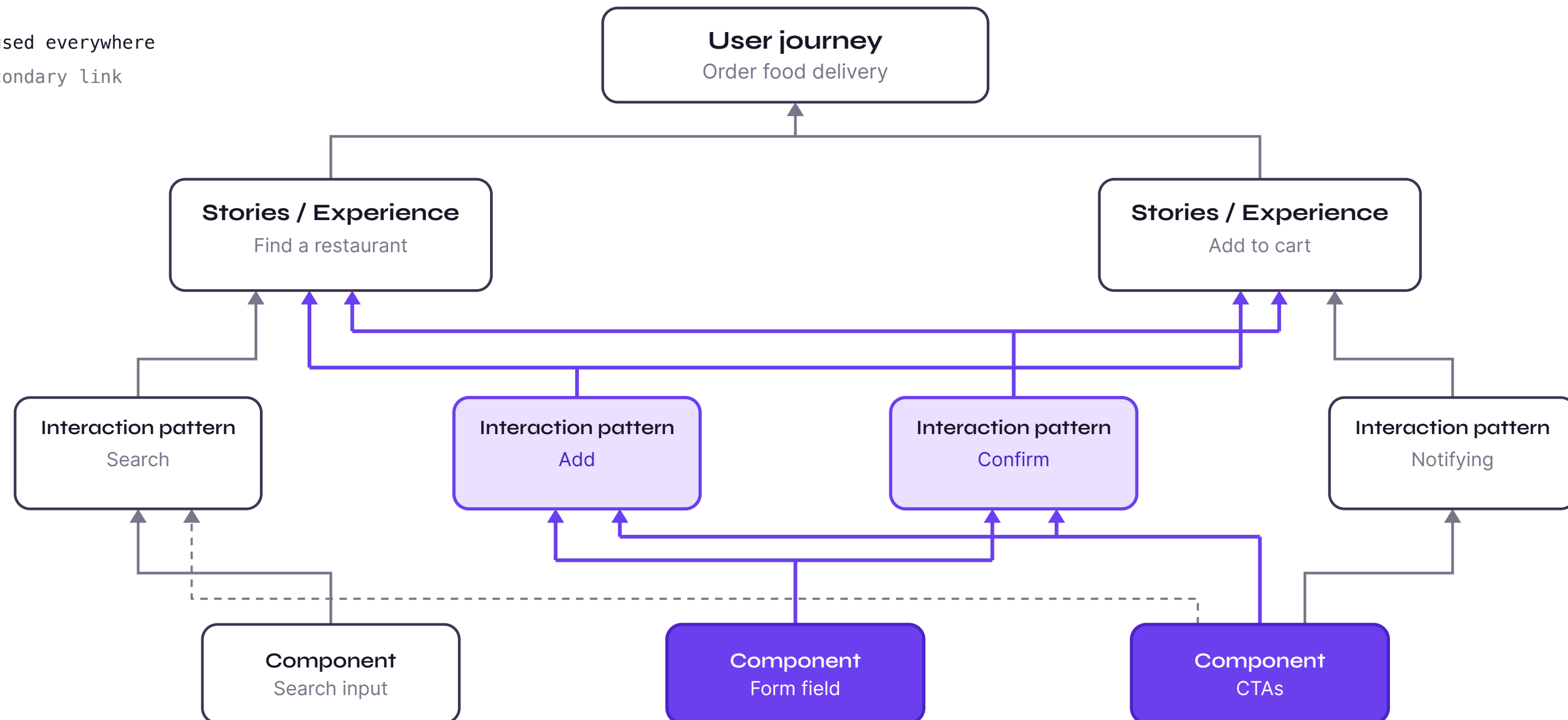


— WHY A DESIGN SYSTEM MATTERS

Build a piece once. Use it **everywhere**.

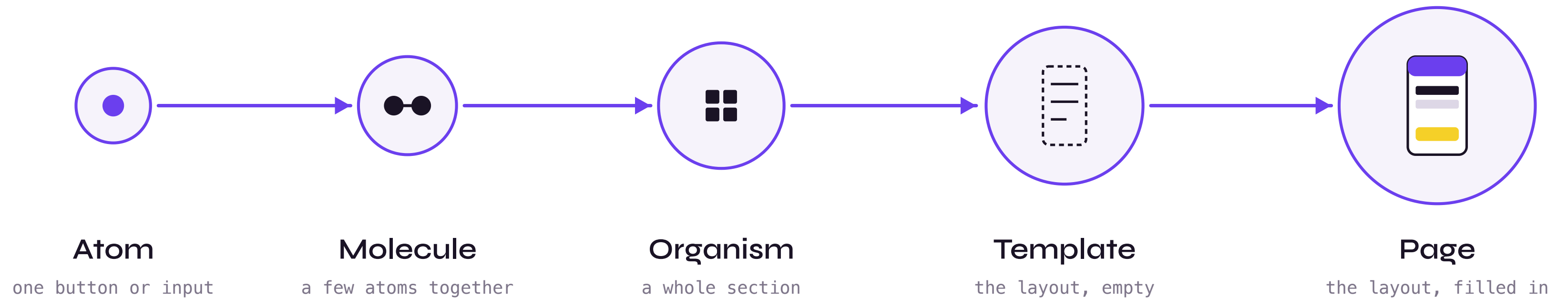
The same **Add** and **Confirm** patterns serve both experiences — and shared components like the **form field** and **buttons** power them underneath. Reuse compounds at every level: build once, use everywhere.

— reused everywhere
- - - secondary link



— MEET ATOMIC DESIGN · BRAD FROST, 2013

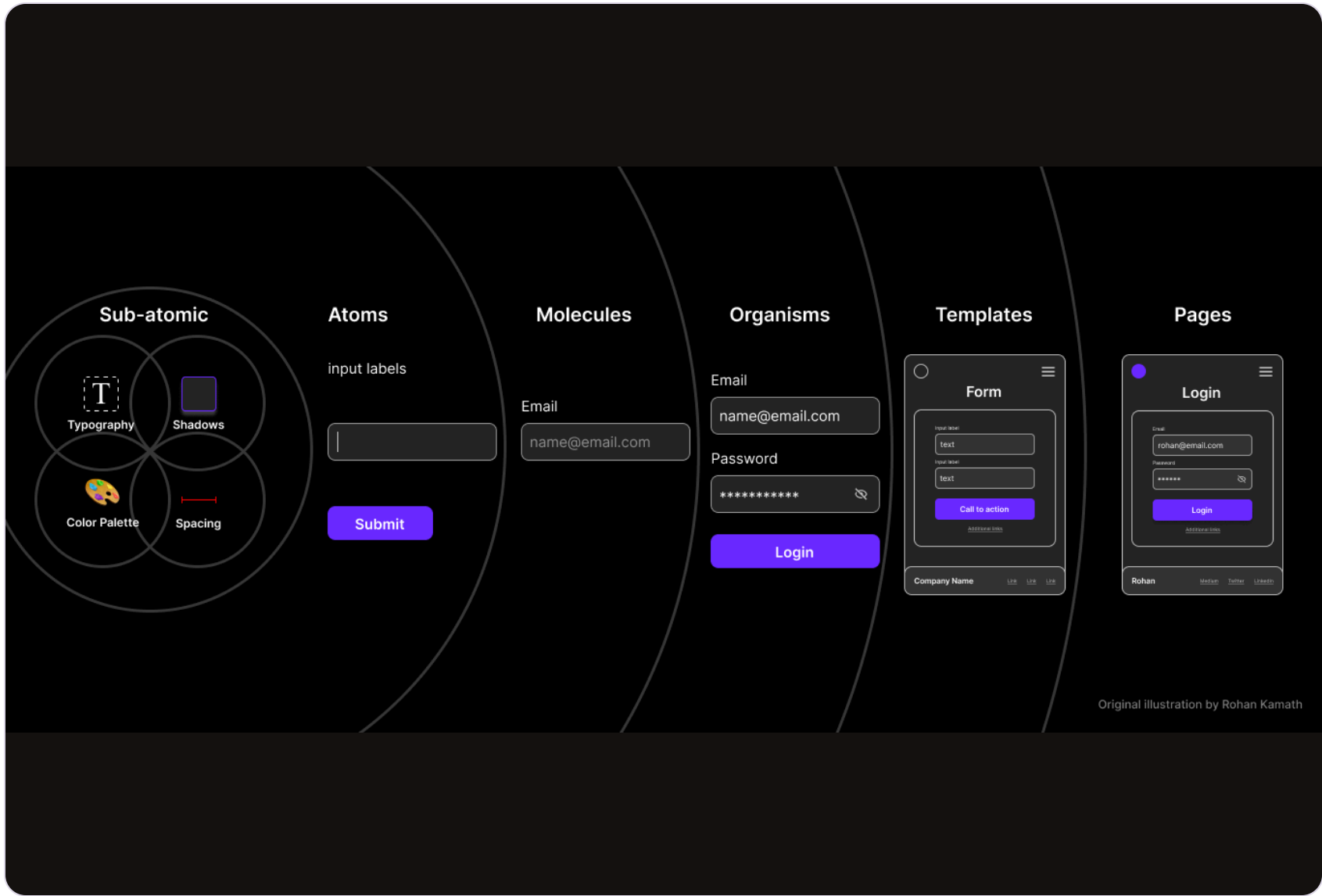
A design system is built in layers.



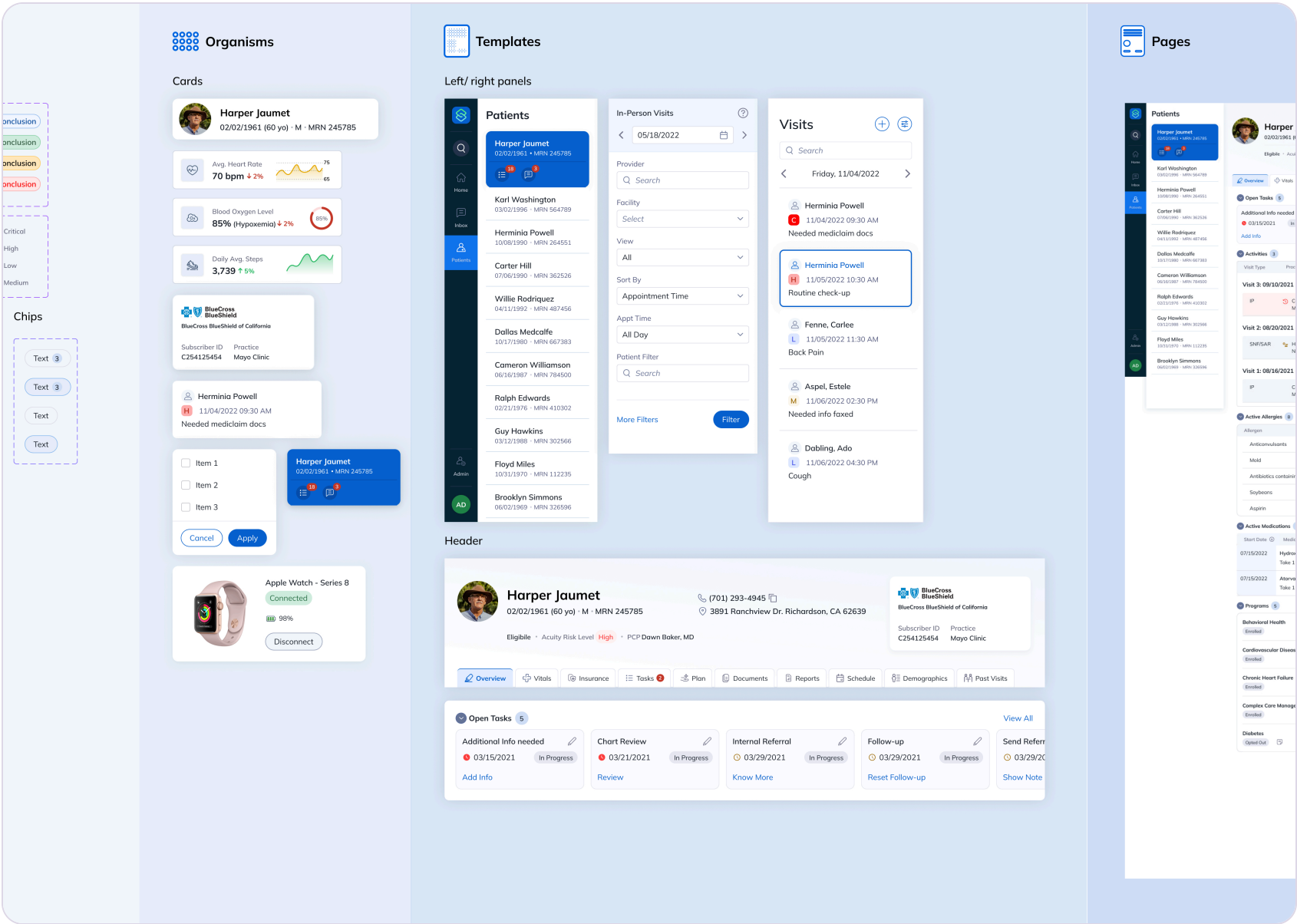
Beneath it all sit **tokens** – your saved colour, spacing and radius values.

— WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

Every app you use is already built **this way.**



One Page traced back through every level – type tokens to final screen.



A real design system – Atoms to Pages, side by side.

Five steps. One system.



● Steps 1–3 · read what you have ● Steps 4–5 · build the system

— BEFORE YOU OPEN FIGMA

Your concept sketch is already a **design blueprint**.

Step 01

Find your screens

Pick the 2–3 screens that capture what users responded to. Write their names — these are your Pages, the destination.



→ [your concept sketch](#)

Step 02

Sketch your zones

Strip one screen of everything — text, images, colour. Draw a grey rectangle for each section and give it a plain name: nav, content, action. That's your Template skeleton.



→ [the Template skeleton](#)

ACTIVITY 01 • YOUR TURN

8 Minutes

Open your concept sketch. Pick your 2–3 most important screens. Draw the skeleton for one of them — grey rectangles only. Give every section a plain name. Come back with your list of zones.

STEP 3 · FROM ZONES TO PATTERNS

Those zones? They each have a **name in design**.

Think about what a user **does** in each zone — navigating, searching, adding, confirming. Those are interaction patterns, and they're exactly how design systems name their Organisms. You already mapped your system without knowing it.

YOUR ZONES

- Navigation area
- Search zone
- Checkout summary



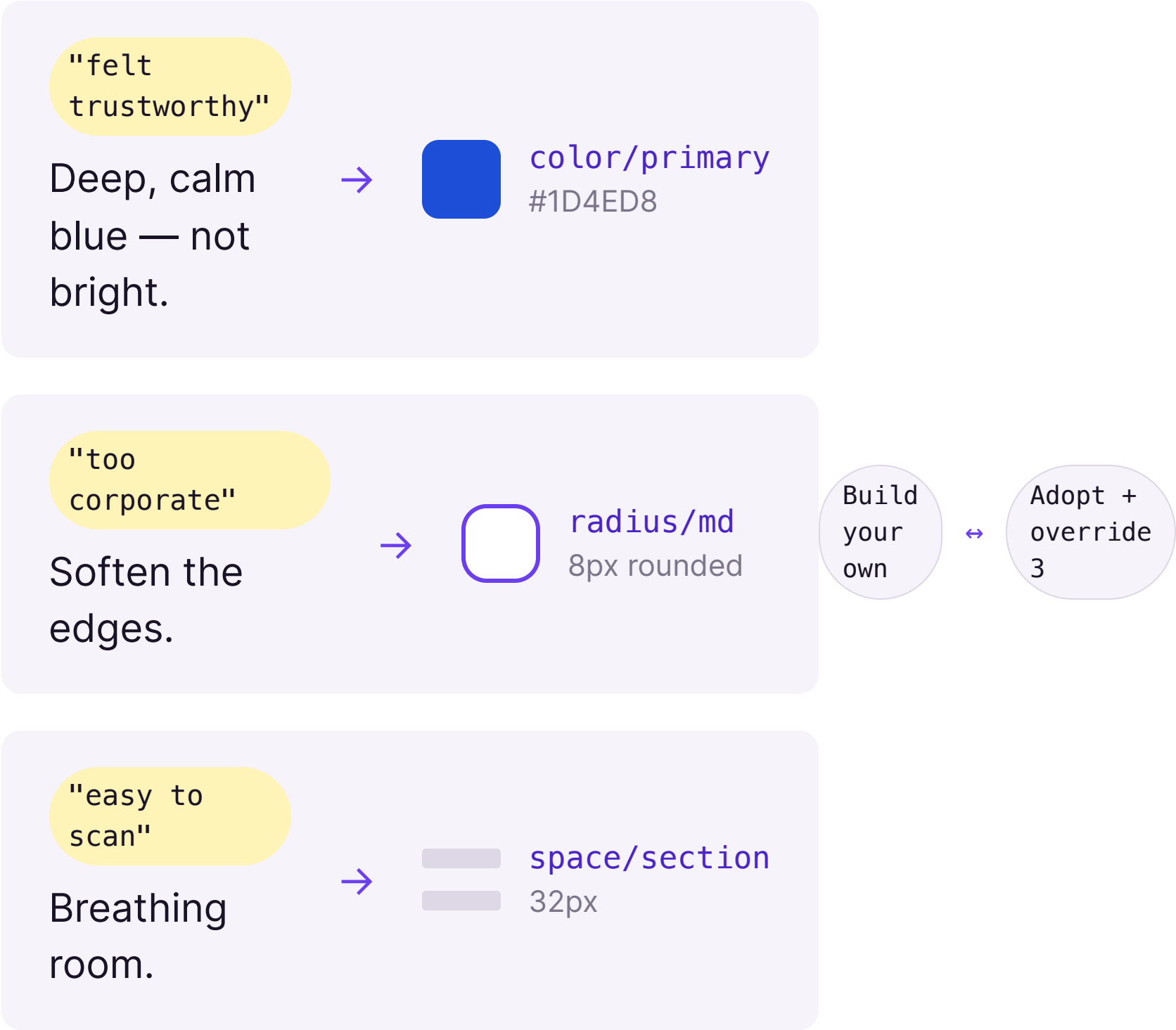
PATTERNS = *Organisms*

- Navigating
- Searching
- Confirming

STEP 4 · BUILD YOUR FOUNDATION — OR BORROW ONE

“Trustworthy” is a colour.
“Approachable” is a
corner radius.

Build your own tokens from your concept's personality — or adopt an existing system and override the few that matter. Either way, every value traces back to what users told you.

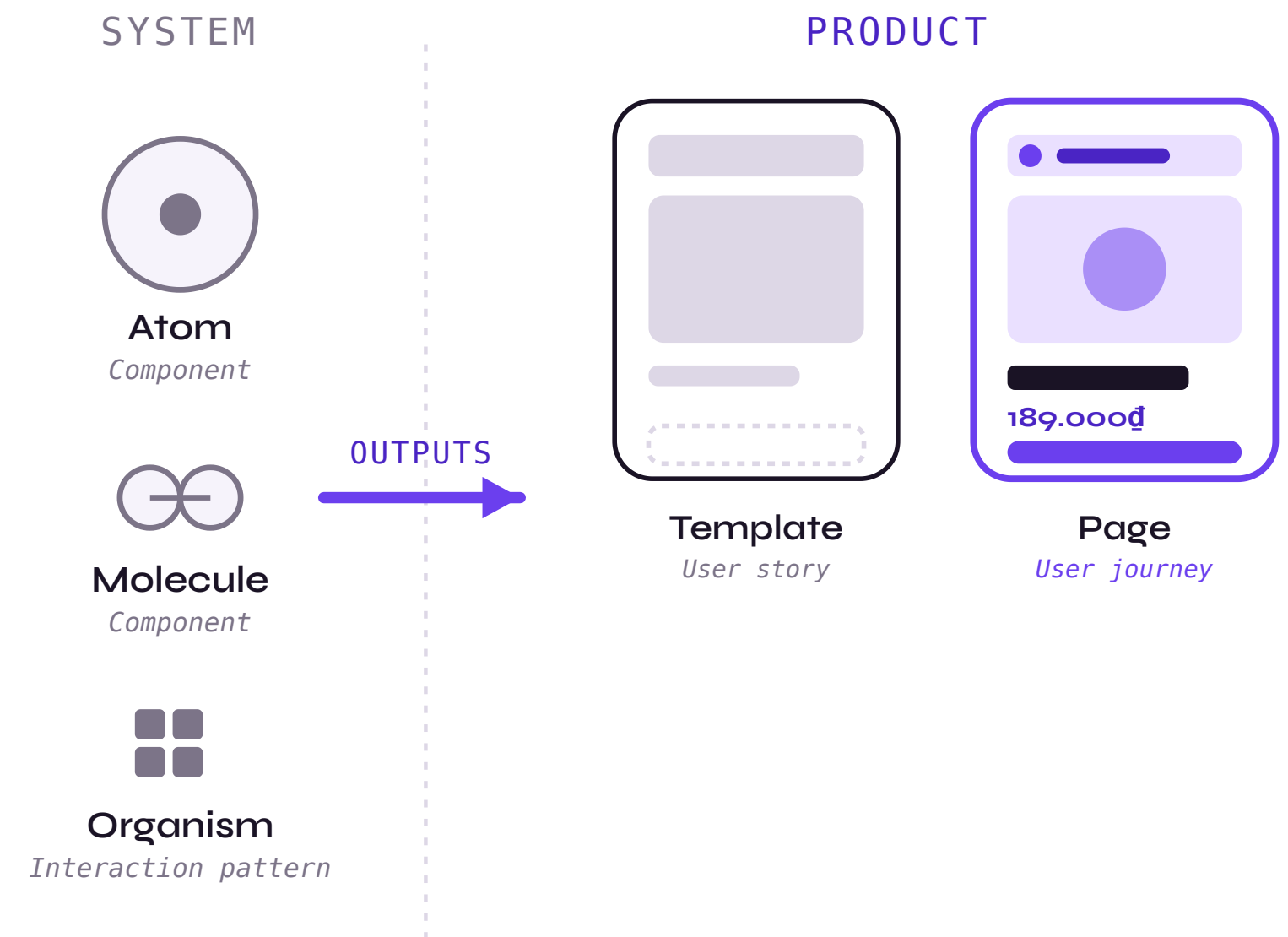


STEP 5 · WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY BUILDING TOWARD

The system **builds**. The product **ships**.

Atoms → Molecules → Organisms is the system.

Template → Page is the product. And each layer maps straight onto the experience architecture you saw earlier.



— YOUR TURN TO BUILD

Steps 4 and 5 are yours to **build**.

★ Your Template is the input for the next session.

Deliverable — a Figma link with tokens, Atoms, Molecules, Organisms, a Template and a Page.

— KEEP LEARNING

↗ Creating Atomic Components in Figma figma.com/blog

↗ Atomic Design System — Community file figma.com

4

Set your foundation — define your tokens, or adopt a system and override 3. One sentence of “why” per custom token.

5

Build the system — 3 Atoms → 2 Molecules → 2 Organisms → assemble your Template → fill a Page. Note what breaks.

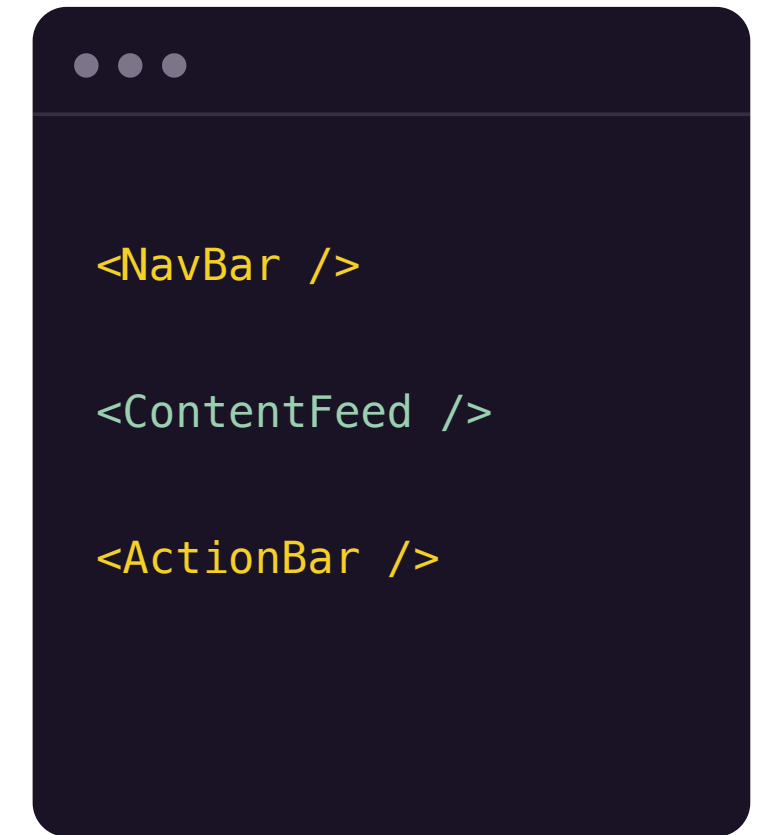
NEXT SESSION

Your Template is not the end. It's the **input**.

Hand it to an AI tool — Cursor or Claude — and watch it become a prototype. The better your system, the better the result.



You build (today)



AI builds (next session)

ONE THING TO CARRY FORWARD

*“Find the screen.
Sketch the zones.
Map the patterns.
Build from tokens.
Ship to the **Page**.”*

Five steps from sketch to system. The Template and Page prove it works.

— *Winnie Nguyen*